MONASH University

MONASH BUSINESS SCHOOL

Developing Good Research Habits

bit.ly/research_habits

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Outline

Alternative titles

There's more to being a researcher than writing a thesis

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What you should know but probably don't

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There's more to being a researcher than writing a thesis

What you should know but probably don't

Listen up, young padawans

Outline

1. Citing
2. Searching
3. Writing
4. Tracking

Managing references

Zotero

- Free and on all operating systems
- Web-version and local version synced
- Browser extension for adding papers/books
- Attach notes and annotations to papers.
- Works with Word, LibreOffice or LaTeX.
- Generate bibliography automatically
- Handles all formatting for you.

zotero

To install:

- Set up account at `www.zotero.org`
- Download from `www.zotero.org`

Managing references

Paperpile

- $3 per month and runs on Google Chrome
- Papers stored on Google Drive
- Browser extension for adding papers/books
- Works with Google Docs or LaTeX.
- Generate bibliography automatically
- Handles all formatting for you.
- Amazingly fast

To install:

- Set up account at `paperpile.com`
- Download Google chrome browser extension

What to cite?

- Cite what is important.
- Cite (only) what is relevant.
- Avoid lists of gratuitous references.
- Include proper citations for all packages and software you use.

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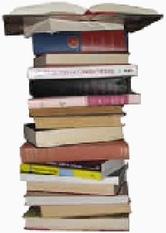
When using R

```
citation("packagename")
```

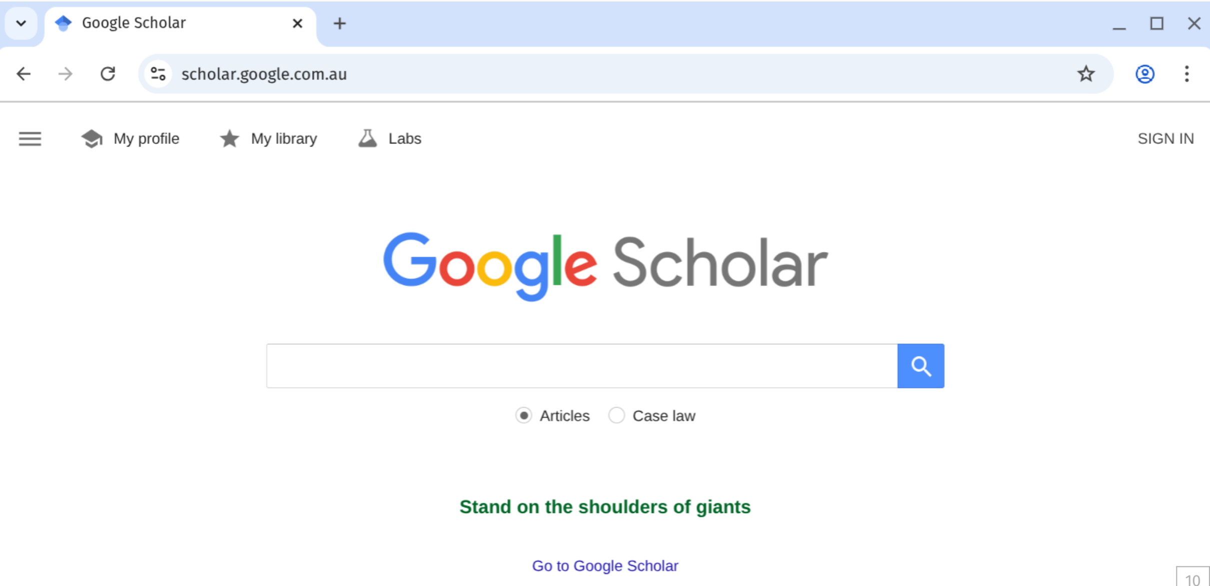
Sight what you cite

- Every article cited should be sighted, & preferably read.
- At the very least, check that the article cited really does say what you think it says.
- Don’t just cite what other people say about citations.
- Store accurate reference info from the start.
- Give credit where it is due.

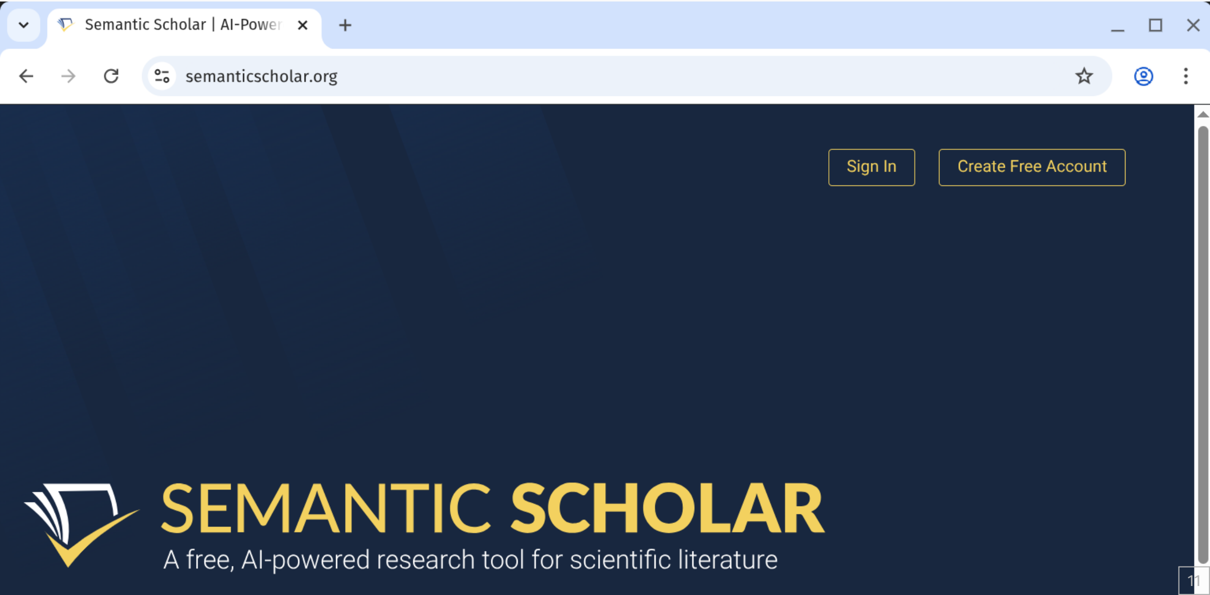


Outline

Google Scholar



Semantic Scholar



Outline

Reproducibility

Not reproducible:

- Data edited in a spreadsheet
- Click and point analysis
- Copy and paste graphs and tables
- Tables typed by hand

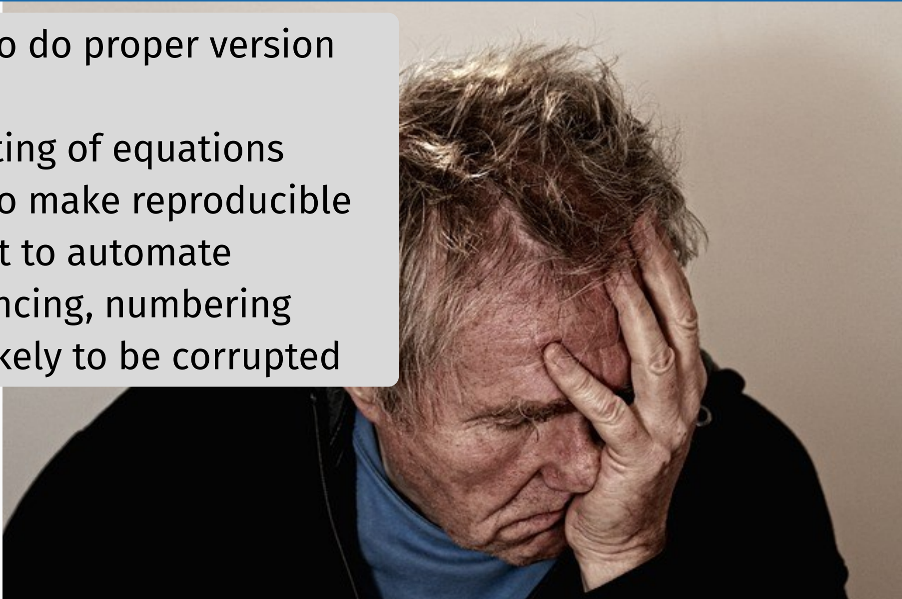
Reproducible

- All data edits scripted
- All analysis scripted
- Graphs and tables automatically pulled in to the thesis
- Tables generated with scripts

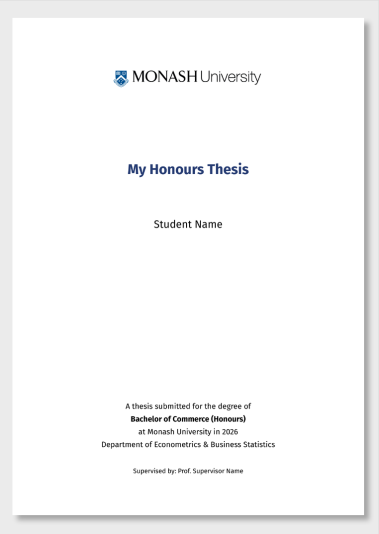
Microsoft Word

Microsoft Word

- Impossible to do proper version control
- Poor formatting of equations
- Impossible to make reproducible
- More difficult to automate cross-referencing, numbering
- Files more likely to be corrupted



Quarto



MONASH University

My Honours Thesis

Student Name

A thesis submitted for the degree of
Bachelor of Commerce (Honours)
at Monash University in 2026
Department of Econometrics & Business Statistics

Supervised by: Prof. Supervisor Name

Quarto

- Combines R and Python code with text in a single file
- Reproducible research
- Monash Thesis Honours Template via `https://GitHub.com/quarto-monash/honours-thesis`
- Useful for assignments too
- See `quarto.org` for help

Outline

Version control

- `thesis_v1`, `thesis_v2`, etc., is not adequate version control.
- You need to track changes over time, have a *remote* repository, and be able to roll back as required.
- Your repository should contain *everything* required to produce your thesis including computer code, references, writing.
- Your repository should have an obvious structure and be fully documented.
- **GitHub** solves these problems
- Read “Happy git with R”: `happygitwithr.com`

Version control with git

- RStudio integrates with GitHub, so version control built in.
- But GitHub can be used with *any* text-based language including Stata, Python, LaTeX, R, Rmarkdown, Quarto, markdown, etc.
- Git allows you to:
  - track changes
  - experiment in branches
  - undo
- GitHub provides:
  - backup and restore
  - synchronisation

Resources

Slides and links:

`bit.ly/research_habits`